
WELCOME



COLLEGE GUIDE: RECRUITING PROCESS

Hi, I'm ALAINA



Hey there! I'm Alaina Valdez and I'm so excited to be working with you.

First up: a little about me. I am the founder of Fifth Gear Pitching. My goal was simple: to make it easier for pitchers to get the proper tools they need.

I am excited to work with you and help you learn the proper mechanics at any age level!

COLLEGE RECRUITING GUIDE

The college recruiting process can feel overwhelming, but it doesn't have to be. From my experience transitioning from SJCC to Santa Clara University, I learned what truly matters when it comes to getting noticed, building relationships with coaches, and finding the right fit. This guide will give you a clear roadmap to navigate the recruiting journey.

When Recruiting Really Starts

For most pitchers, coaches begin watching around freshman or sophomore year of high school. Don't panic if you're a late bloomer-there's a path for every timeline.

Building a Strong Player Profile

Coaches look for:

- Consistency in pitching mechanics
- Mental toughness under pressure
- Strong academics and character

Start a simple highlight reel that shows game situations, not just practice.

How to Reach Out to Coaches

Be proactive! Send short, professional emails that include:

- Intro (name, position, grad year)
- Academic info (GPA, SAT/ACT if applicable)
- Link to highlight reel
- Upcoming tournament schedule

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Showcases and Camps

College camps and showcase events are great ways to get seen. Research which schools truly fit you, so you're investing time in the right events.

Choosing the Right Fit

Remember, it's not just about the scholarship-it's about where you'll grow the most as a person, student, and athlete. Ask yourself:

- Do I like the team culture?
- Can I thrive academically here?
- Does the coaching style match how I learn best?

What I Learned Moving to D1

At SCU, I realized that relationships matter as much as stats. Coaches want players who bring value on and off the field. Work ethic, attitude, and resilience are just as important as speed or velocity.

RECRUITING CHECKLIST

- ☒ Create a simple highlight reel
- ☒ Researched schools that fit academically and athletically
- ☒ Reached out to coaches with clear emails
- ☒ Attended camps/showcases strategically
- ☒ Asked myself the big questions about fit and culture